

D218

Intrapersonal Leadership and Professional Growth

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A nurse on a busy 32-bed medical unit notices that she gets short with coworkers whenever her assignment includes more than five patients. Her unit was recently recognized for low fall rates. She wants to lead more effectively. Using emotional intelligence models, which step comes first?

- A. Take a course on persuading coworkers to follow her lead.
- B. Review the unit's fall-prevention data with her manager.
- C. Suppress all emotions at work so they never show.
- D. Build self-awareness by noticing her own triggers and how her reactions affect others.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

After a rapid response call, a new graduate nurse writes a reflection. She has described what happened, recorded how she felt, and judged what went well and poorly. The patient was transferred to the ICU at 0300. Using Gibbs' reflective cycle, what should she do next?

- A. Rewrite the description with more detail.
- B. Analyze why events unfolded as they did and what factors shaped them.
- C. Look up the ICU transfer criteria for 0300 admissions.
- D. Write an action plan for next time.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

An RN on a surgical unit with a strong teamwork culture has four post-op patients and one unlicensed assistive personnel (UAP) who has worked there ten years. Which task can the RN appropriately delegate to the UAP?

- A. Teaching a patient to self-inject insulin before discharge.
- B. Measuring and recording vital signs on a stable patient.
- C. Any task, because the UAP's ten years on the unit outweighs a license.
- D. Doing the admission assessment on a new post-op patient.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An RN delegated vital signs to a UAP, and a set of readings was recorded wrong and never reported. Who keeps accountability for the delegation decision and follow-up?

- A.** Only the UAP, because the task was handed off.
- B.** No one, because vital signs are always routine.
- C.** The RN, who remains accountable for delegating properly and supervising; the UAP is responsible for doing the task correctly.
- D.** The charge nurse, who made the assignments.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A nurse has cared for a lonely older patient for two weeks on a rehab unit that allows flexible visiting hours. The patient asks the nurse to be friends on social media after discharge. Which response best protects professional boundaries?

- A.** Accept once the patient is discharged, since the professional relationship has ended.
- B.** Kindly decline and explain that her role is professional, while acknowledging the patient's progress.
- C.** Let the patient decide, since boundaries are the patient's responsibility.
- D.** Refuse to speak with the patient again and ask to be reassigned.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A nurse manager of a unit with 18% turnover shares a vision of becoming the hospital's best teaching unit, coaches each nurse on personal goals, and invites staff to redesign handoff. The unit recently moved to a new building. Which leadership style is she using?

- A.** Transformational
- B.** Transactional
- C.** Laissez-faire
- D.** Autocratic, because high turnover requires tight control

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A charge nurse gives first pick of shifts to staff who meet documentation targets and issues warnings to those who miss them. Which leadership style is this?

- A.** Servant
- B.** Democratic
- C.** Transactional
- D.** Transformational

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A nurse with four years on the same cardiac step-down unit, where she also serves on the scheduling committee, sees situations as wholes and quickly recognizes which details matter most, but still uses analytical thinking to decide what to do. Under Benner's model, which stage fits best?

- A.** Proficient
- B.** Expert, because committee service shows mastery
- C.** Competent
- D.** Advanced beginner, because every nurse stays in that stage until year five

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A newly graduated nurse notices recurring meaningful aspects of situations but needs help setting priorities and follows rules closely. Which Benner stage fits?

- A.** Expert
- B.** Novice
- C.** Competent
- D.** Advanced beginner

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

During a busy shift on a unit that just adopted a new EHR, a physician raises his voice at a nurse in front of a patient's family about a delayed lab draw. The family has visited daily for a week. Which response is assertive?

- A.** Complain to the family about the physician afterward.
- B.** Apologize and say nothing more.
- C.** Calmly ask to step aside and say, "I want to fix the lab delay, and I need us to talk without raised voices."
- D.** Raise her voice to match his so he backs down.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which statement is aggressive rather than assertive?

- A.** "You never listen to nurses, and you're making this unit unsafe."
- B.** Any time a nurse says no to a request is aggressive.
- C.** "I'm concerned about this dose, and I need you to review it before I give it."
- D.** "I feel rushed when assignments change without notice; can we plan earlier?"

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A nurse on a pediatric oncology unit has had three patient deaths in a month. She feels drained, detached from families, and less effective. Her unit won a regional award last spring. What is the best first step?

- A.** Take a continuing education course on chemotherapy drugs.
- B.** Pick up extra shifts to stay too busy to dwell on it.
- C.** Leave nursing now, since burnout is permanent.
- D.** Recognize the signs of burnout and use support such as debriefing and the employee assistance program.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A nurse on a busy ~~32-bed~~ medical unit notices that she gets short with coworkers whenever her assignment includes more than five patients. ~~Her unit was recently recognized for low fall rates.~~ She wants to lead more effectively. Using emotional intelligence models, which step comes first?

Target word: first EI step **Decides:** She must recognize her own triggers before managing them or others.

A	Adjacent category	Social skill is a later component that depends on self-awareness.
B	Camouflage	The fall-rate detail does not address her reactions.
C	Absolute language	EI is about recognizing and managing emotions, not eliminating them.
D	Correct	Self-awareness is the foundation of emotional intelligence.

2. Answer B Concept 2

After a rapid response call, a new graduate nurse writes a reflection. She has described what happened, recorded how she felt, and judged what went well and poorly. ~~The patient was transferred to the ICU at 0300.~~ Using Gibbs' reflective cycle, what should she do next?

Target word: next Gibbs stage **Decides:** Evaluation is done; analysis follows.

A	Inverted operation	Moves backward in the cycle.
B	Correct	Analysis follows evaluation and turns experience into learning.
C	Camouflage	The transfer time does not decide the next reflective step.
D	Dropped element	Skips analysis and conclusion.

3. Answer B Concept 3

An RN on a surgical unit ~~with a strong teamwork culture~~ has four post-op patients and one unlicensed assistive personnel (UAP) ~~who has worked there ten years.~~ Which task can the RN appropriately delegate to the UAP?

Target word: delegable task **Decides:** Routine, predictable tasks on stable patients can be delegated; assessment and teaching cannot.

A	Confusion set	Patient teaching stays with the RN.
B	Correct	A routine task with a predictable outcome on a stable patient.
C	Camouflage	Experience does not change what can legally be delegated.
D	Adjacent category	Assessment requires RN judgment.

4. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

An RN delegated vital signs to a UAP, and a set of readings was recorded wrong and never reported. Who keeps accountability for the delegation decision and follow-up?

Target word: who is accountable **Decides:** Accountability for delegation stays with the RN.

A	Inverted operation	Accountability does not transfer with the task.
B	Absolute language	Routine tasks still require supervision and follow-up.
C	Correct	Tasks can be delegated; accountability cannot.
D	Adjacent category	The delegating RN keeps accountability for her own delegation.

5. Answer B Concept 4

A nurse has cared for a lonely older patient for two weeks on a rehab unit ~~that allows flexible visiting hours.~~ The patient asks the nurse to be friends on social media after discharge. Which response best protects professional boundaries?

Target word: boundary-keeping response **Decides:** The nurse is responsible for keeping the relationship professional.

A	Confusion set	Boundary duties do not end at discharge.
B	Correct	Keeps the relationship therapeutic without rejecting the patient as a person.
C	Inverted operation	The nurse, not the patient, holds responsibility for boundaries.
D	Absolute language	An overreaction that harms the therapeutic relationship.

6. Answer A Concept 5

A nurse manager of a unit ~~with 18% turnover~~ shares a vision of becoming the hospital's best teaching unit, coaches each nurse on personal goals, and invites staff to redesign handoff. ~~The unit recently moved to a new building.~~ Which leadership style is she using?

Target word: leadership style **Decides:** Vision, coaching, and shared ownership.

A	Correct	Inspires with vision and develops individuals.
B	Confusion set	Transactional relies on rewards and penalties, not vision.
C	Adjacent category	Hands-off leadership; she is actively engaged.
D	Camouflage	The turnover figure does not describe what she actually does.

7. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A charge nurse gives first pick of shifts to staff who meet documentation targets and issues warnings to those who miss them. Which leadership style is this?

Target word: style from behavior **Decides:** Rewards and penalties exchanged for performance.

A	Adjacent category	Servant leaders focus on meeting followers' needs.
B	Confusion set	No shared decision-making is described.
C	Correct	An exchange of rewards and consequences for meeting targets.
D	Inverted operation	No vision or development, only exchange.

8. Answer A Concept 6

A nurse with four years on the same cardiac step-down unit, ~~where she also serves on the scheduling committee,~~ sees situations as wholes and quickly recognizes which details matter most, but still uses analytical thinking to decide what to do. Under Benner's model, which stage fits best?

Target word: Benner stage **Decides:** Holistic perception with some reliance on analysis = proficient.

A	Correct	Proficient nurses see situations as wholes but still decide analytically.
B	Camouflage	Committee work does not define clinical stage; experts act intuitively.
C	Confusion set	Competent nurses plan deliberately and do not yet see situations as wholes.
D	Absolute language	Stage reflects perception, not a fixed number of years.

9. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

A newly graduated nurse notices recurring meaningful aspects of situations but needs help setting priorities and follows rules closely. Which Benner stage fits?

Target word: stage from description **Decides:** Recognizes recurring aspects with guidance = advanced beginner.

A	Inverted operation	Experts rely on intuition, not rules.
B	Adjacent category	Novices have no experience of the situations at all.
C	Confusion set	Competent nurses set priorities through conscious planning.
D	Correct	Benner places most new graduates here.

10. Answer C Concept 7

During a busy shift on a unit ~~that just adopted a new EHR~~, a physician raises his voice at a nurse in front of a patient's family about a delayed lab draw. ~~The family has visited daily for a week.~~ Which response is assertive?

Target word: assertive response **Decides:** Direct, respectful, solution-focused, and private.

A	Adjacent category	Indirect, passive-aggressive, and unprofessional.
B	Confusion set	That is passive communication.
C	Correct	States her need and moves toward a solution respectfully.
D	Inverted operation	That is aggressive, not assertive.

11. Answer A Concept 7 · transfer

Which statement is aggressive rather than assertive?

Target word: spot the aggressive statement **Decides:** Blaming "you" language and absolutes attack the person.

A	Correct	Blames and generalizes instead of addressing the issue.
B	Absolute language	Saying no respectfully is assertive.
C	Confusion set	A clear, respectful, assertive request.
D	Adjacent category	An "I" statement that proposes a solution is assertive.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A nurse on a pediatric oncology unit has had three patient deaths in a month. She feels drained, detached from families, and less effective. ~~Her unit won a regional award last spring.~~ What is the best first step?

Target word: professional self-care response **Decides:** Exhaustion, detachment, and reduced effectiveness = burnout signs.

A	Adjacent category	Builds knowledge but does not address emotional exhaustion.
B	Inverted operation	More workload deepens burnout.
C	Absolute language	Burnout can be addressed with support and change.
D	Correct	Naming it and seeking support is the professional first step.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Emotional intelligence starts with self-awareness	Self-awareness (knowing your own emotions and triggers) is the base for self-regulation, empathy, and social skill.	Jumping to persuading or managing others first.	A nurse reacting to her own triggers.
2	Gibbs' reflective cycle	Description → feelings → evaluation → analysis → conclusion → action plan; learning comes from analysis, not retelling.	Skipping from "what went well" straight to an action plan.	"What should she do next in her reflection?"
3	Delegation and accountability	An RN may delegate routine tasks for stable patients but not assessment, teaching, evaluation, or judgment, and keeps accountability for the delegation.	Believing accountability transfers with the task.	UAP, stable vs. new patient, assessment vs. task.
4	Professional boundaries	The nurse is responsible for keeping the relationship therapeutic, including after discharge and on social media.	Thinking discharge ends boundary duties or that the patient sets them.	Gifts, friend requests, personal favors.
5	Transformational vs. transactional leadership	Transformational leaders inspire with vision and develop people; transactional leaders exchange rewards and penalties for performance.	Calling any effective or goal-driven leader transformational.	Vision and coaching vs. rewards tied to targets.
6	Benner's novice to expert	Novice → advanced beginner → competent → proficient (sees situations as wholes) → expert (intuitive grasp); stage reflects how the nurse perceives situations, not just years.	Assigning stage by years or titles alone.	How the nurse sees and prioritizes a situation.
7	Assertive communication	Assertive = direct, respectful, owns needs ("I" statements), and seeks a solution; aggressive attacks; passive withdraws.	Mistaking loud or blaming talk for assertiveness.	Conflict with a colleague and a choice of replies.
8	Burnout and self-care	Emotional exhaustion, detachment, and reduced effectiveness signal burnout; the professional response is to recognize it and use support resources.	Working harder or quitting as the only options.	Drained, detached, less effective after repeated stress.

Course scope (public description): Intrapersonal Leadership and Professional Growth focuses on helping students build a strong professional identity. In this course, students will explore theories, skills, leadership standards, education, and professionalism in nursing. Students will learn how nurses can develop a leadership mindset to take charge, influence others, and demonstrate authority in their work and personal lives.